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REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

DOD-CNDO-2026-044

Classified Network Defense Operations Support

Issuing Agency: Department of Defense

Contracting Office: Defense Information Systems Agency (DISA) — Cyber Directorate

Solicitation Number: DOD-CNDO-2026-044

NAICS Code: 541512 — Computer Systems Design Services

Set-Aside: 8(a) Set-Aside

Proposal Due Date: August 1, 2026, 2:00 PM Eastern Time

Period of Performance: 12-month base period + two (2) one-year option periods

Place of Performance: Fort Meade, MD — Sensitive Compartmented Information Facility (SCIF). All work under this contract is performed at a designated government SCIF. No remote or telework arrangements are permitted.

This procurement is a **8(a) Set-Aside** reserved exclusively for SBA-certified 8(a) Business Development Program participants. Only firms holding current, active SBA 8(a) certification at the time of proposal submission are eligible to compete for this award.

All offerors and all personnel proposed to perform under this contract must hold active Top Secret security clearances with Sensitive Compartmented Information (SCI) eligibility at the time of proposal submission. Clearance sponsorship is NOT available under this contract. The Government will not grant interim clearances for purposes of performance.

Proposals must be submitted via SIPRNet secure email to the designated Contracting Officer. Unclassified submissions via SAM.gov will not be accepted. Access to proposal submission instructions requires an active TS/SCI clearance.

SECTION C — STATEMENT OF WORK

C.1 Background and Mission Context

The Department of Defense (DOD) operates a global classified network infrastructure supporting warfighting, intelligence, and command-and-control functions. Classified DOD enclaves — including SECRET and TOP SECRET//SCI networks — face continuous, sophisticated threats from nation-state adversaries and Advanced Persistent Threat (APT) actors. The mission of this contract is to provide continuous, expert-level network defense operations across DOD classified enclave infrastructure at Fort Meade, MD.

The contractor will embed cleared personnel within a SCIF environment, operating alongside DOD Cyber Mission Forces (CMF), the DOD Cyber Crime Center (DC3), and US Cyber Command (US-CYBERCOM). All work is performed on classified networks. Personnel who cannot obtain and maintain active Top Secret clearances with SCI eligibility are ineligible to perform any task under this contract.

C.2 Continuous Monitoring of Classified DOD Networks

The contractor shall provide continuous 24/7/365 monitoring of classified DOD network infrastructure within designated SCIFs at Fort Meade. Monitoring activities include: (a) real-time analysis of network traffic on SECRET and TOP SECRET network segments; (b) correlation of intrusion detection system (IDS) and host-based security system (HBSS) alerts; (c) identification of anomalous traffic patterns indicative of APT lateral movement; and (d) continuous dashboard monitoring of classified SIEM feeds. All monitoring is conducted from within the SCIF using government-furnished classified workstations. No unclassified connectivity is permitted during operations.

C.3 Incident Response within SCIFs

The contractor shall provide Incident Response (IR) services for classified security incidents affecting DOD enclave networks. IR responsibilities include: (a) initial triage and classification of suspected breaches or intrusion events on SECRET and TS/SCI network segments; (b) forensic analysis of classified endpoints, servers, and network appliances within SCIF boundaries; (c) containment, eradication, and recovery activities coordinated with the Government IR lead; (d) preparation of classified incident reports compliant with CJCSI 6510.01F and DoDD 8530.01; and (e) briefings to senior DOD leadership within designated SAPs as required. All incident documentation shall be classified at the appropriate level and stored on government-furnished classified systems only.

C.4 Threat Hunting Against APT-Tier Adversaries

The contractor shall conduct proactive threat hunting operations targeting APT-tier nation-state adversaries known to target DOD classified networks. Threat hunting activities shall include: (a) hypothesis-driven hunting campaigns based on current classified threat intelligence products disseminated by NSA/CSS, DIA, and US-CYBERCOM J2; (b) analysis of classified MITRE ATT&CK; for ICS and Enterprise threat actor profiles; (c) custom signature development for classified IDS/IPS platforms; and (d) adversary emulation exercises using classified red team indicators. Hunting results shall be briefed weekly to the DOD Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) in a classified setting.

C.5 Coordination with DOD CIRT and US-CYBERCOM JFHQ-DODIN

The contractor shall coordinate directly with the DOD Computer Incident Response Team (CIRT) and the Joint Force Headquarters — Department of Defense Information Networks (JFHQ-DODIN) under US Cyber Command. Coordination activities include: (a) daily operations synchronization calls (classified); (b) submission of cyber incident reports via classified DOD reporting channels (SIPR/JWICS); (c) participation in classified threat intelligence sharing sessions with JFHQ-DODIN and allied Cyber Mission Forces; and (d) support for DOD Inspector General (IG) audits and assessments as directed. All coordination occurs within classified environments. The contractor's cleared personnel must be authorized for access to relevant SAPs as required by the Government Security Officer.

SECTION H — SPECIAL CONTRACT REQUIREMENTS

H.1 Security Clearance Requirements

H.1.1 Mandatory Clearance Level. All personnel performing under this contract shall hold an active Top Secret clearance with SCI eligibility at the time of proposal submission. Clearance sponsorship is NOT available under this contract. Offerors that cannot demonstrate a cleared workforce meeting this requirement at the time of proposal submission will be deemed ineligible for award without further evaluation.

H.1.2 Continuous Clearance Maintenance. All contractor personnel must maintain their Top Secret clearance with SCI eligibility throughout the period of performance. Any personnel whose clearances are suspended, revoked, or not renewed must be immediately removed from contract performance and replaced with equally or more highly cleared personnel within five (5) business days. The contractor shall notify the Contracting Officer within 24 hours of any clearance action affecting personnel assigned to this contract.

H.1.3 Key Personnel Clearance Certification. With the proposal, the offeror shall submit a signed Personnel Security Certification (PSC) confirming that all proposed Key Personnel hold current, active TS/SCI clearances. The PSC shall be signed by the offeror's Facility Security Officer (FSO) and submitted via SIPRNet. Proposals submitted without a valid PSC will be rejected as technically unacceptable.

H.1.4 SIPRNet Infrastructure Requirement. The contractor must maintain an active SIPRNet connection at their cleared facility prior to award. Proposals must include the contractor's SIPRNet IP address for communications. All proposal submissions, correspondence, and deliverables under this contract are transmitted via SIPRNet or hand-carried by cleared personnel. No NIPRNet or unclassified email communication is permitted for official contract matters.

H.2 SBA 8(a) Set-Aside Requirements

H.2.1 8(a) Certification Mandatory. This procurement is reserved for SBA-certified 8(a) Business Development Program participants in good standing. Offerors must hold current, active SBA 8(a) certification at the time of proposal submission. Certification must remain active through contract award. Proposals from firms that are not SBA-certified 8(a) participants will be rejected without evaluation.

H.2.2 8(a) Documentation Required. The offeror shall submit with its proposal a copy of its current SBA 8(a) certification letter issued by the Small Business Administration. The letter must be dated within 12 months of proposal due date. The offeror's SBA case number shall appear in the certification documentation. Proposals lacking valid 8(a) certification documentation will be rejected as technically unacceptable.

H.2.3 Subcontracting Limitations. Consistent with SBA 8(a) program limitations on subcontracting, the prime contractor shall perform at least 50% of the cost of the contract with its own workforce. Subcontracting to non-8(a) firms is permitted only for non-primary requirements and must be approved in advance by the SBA and the Contracting Officer.

SECTION L — INSTRUCTIONS TO OFFERORS

L.1 SIPRNet Submission Only

All proposals must be submitted via SIPRNet secure email to the Contracting Officer at the SIPRNet address provided in the classified amendment to this solicitation. Unclassified submissions via SAM.gov, commercial email, or any other unclassified channel will NOT be accepted and will be rejected without evaluation. Offerors without SIPRNet access are ineligible to submit proposals under this solicitation, as SIPRNet access requires an active TS/SCI clearance.

L.2 Volume Structure

Proposals shall consist of four volumes submitted via SIPRNet: Volume I — Technical Approach (classified, page limit: 40 pages); Volume II — Personnel Security Certification and Key Personnel Resumes (classified, no page limit); Volume III — 8(a) Certification Documentation (unclassified, submitted separately via hand delivery to the Contracting Officer if SIPRNet not available for this volume); Volume IV — Price/Cost (unclassified, page limit: none).

L.3 Proposal Validity Period

Proposals shall remain valid for a minimum of 180 days after the proposal due date. Proposals with shorter validity periods may be rejected at the Government's discretion. The Government anticipates award within 120 days of proposal due date, subject to security clearance verification timelines.

SECTION M — EVALUATION CRITERIA

M.1 Evaluation Method — Best Value Tradeoff

Award will be made using a Best Value Tradeoff source selection. Evaluation factors, listed in descending order of importance, are: (1) Clearance Posture (eliminary gate); (2) Technical Approach; (3) Past Performance with classified cybersecurity work; (4) Price/Cost. Technical factors, when combined, are more important than Price.

M.2 Clearance Posture — Eliminary Gate

M.2.1 Gate Criteria. Before any other evaluation factor is considered, the Government will verify that all proposed Key Personnel hold active Top Secret clearances with SCI eligibility and that the offeror holds a valid SBA 8(a) certification. Proposals that fail either gate — insufficient clearance posture OR absence of valid 8(a) certification — will be rejected without further evaluation. No exceptions or waivers are available for these eliminary requirements.

M.2.2 Clearance Verification. The Contracting Officer will verify clearance status through the Joint Personnel Adjudication System (JPAS) or its successor system. Offerors are responsible for ensuring their personnel's clearance information is current in JPAS at the time of proposal submission. Discrepancies between the submitted PSC and JPAS records will result in proposal rejection.

M.3 Technical Approach

Technical Approach will be evaluated on: (a) demonstrated understanding of classified network defense operations and APT threat landscape; (b) proposed methodology for continuous monitoring of TS/SCI network segments; (c) incident response procedures tailored to SCIF environments; and (d) threat hunting approach leveraging classified intelligence sources. Proposals will be rated Outstanding, Good, Acceptable, Marginal, or Unacceptable on Technical Approach.

M.4 Past Performance with Classified Work

Past Performance will be evaluated based on the quality and relevance of prior classified cybersecurity engagements. Relevant experience includes prior DOD, IC, or other federal classified network defense contracts. Unclassified past performance may be submitted but carries less weight than classified engagements. Offerors with no relevant classified past performance will receive a Neutral rating. Past Performance ratings: Substantial Confidence, Satisfactory Confidence, Limited Confidence, No Confidence, or Neutral.

M.5 Price/Cost

Price will be evaluated for reasonableness, completeness, and realism. Offerors must provide fully-burdened labor rates for all proposed cleared labor categories, reflecting appropriate cleared-workforce compensation premiums. Price will not be scored; however, a significantly higher price than the Government cost estimate must be justified by clearly superior non-price factors to result in award.